



### New Nintendo Switch announced

Nintendo's new OLED Switch will be available on October 8th for \$350. <https://digit.in/jul21-93>



### Japan to reignite silicon industry

The country has fallen behind despite hosting more chip factories than any other country. <https://digit.in/jul21-94>

# MSI Pulse GL66 Gaming Laptop

## Hits the sweet spot for 1080p gaming

**T**he MSI Pulse GL66 is powered by the 11th Gen Intel Core i7-11800H with 8 cores and 16 threads. It appears to be a well-rounded package for gamers who are eyeing 1080p gaming on their laptop. Does it deliver on that front? Let's find out in our full review.

### DESIGN & BUILD QUALITY

The MSI Pulse GL66 is mainly built out of plastic with the exception of the lid. Despite the plastic build, the chassis doesn't flex at all when stressed. The lid can be opened with a single hand and the hinge feels nice and stable. The bezels are quite slim, but both the chin and the forehead are relatively more pronounced. Coming in at just 2.25kg, it's not the heaviest thing on the market in the name of a gaming laptop.

### PERFORMANCE

The MSI Pulse GL66 is powered by one of the newer H45 processors from Intel. It's the Core i7 11800H in this case. For graphics, it has an RTX 3060 GPU with 6GB VRAM and it's got a TGP of 80W with 5W more for boost. Additionally, you get 16GB DDR4 RAM on board, 1TB NVMe drive, and a 1080p display with a refresh rate of 144Hz.

For content creators, the 8 cores on the Core i7-11800H and the 3060 will deliver reliable performance too. For example, we were able to export a 5 mins 1080p project in just a minute 41 seconds in Davinci Resolve.

In the 3DMark tests, MSI Pulse GL66 scored 4,643 in FireStrike Ultra, and 7,271 in the Time Spy test. The scores here are slightly less than what the Zephyrus G15 managed to score.

### THERMALS

Both CPU as well as the GPU were able to handle the loads very well. The CPU



|                       |    |
|-----------------------|----|
| BUILD AND DESIGN..... | 72 |
| FEATURES.....         | 65 |
| PERFORMANCE.....      | 65 |
| VALUE.....            | 66 |



Price  
₹1,39,990

was sitting at around 90 degrees C, which is way under its TJMax limit, and even the GPU was running surprisingly cool in this chassis.

We recorded a surface temperature of around 55°C at the hottest point. The fans on this machine get very aggressively loud, so do keep that in mind.

### DISPLAY

You get a 15.6-inch 1080p panel here with a 144z refresh rate. Now, our experience while gaming on this laptop wasn't anything out of the ordinary. It's a basic 1080p panel that's suited for gaming thanks to the higher refresh rate. The main issue, however, is with colour accuracy. The display showed heavy bias towards the blue colour. A lot of other colours also ended up showing a huge variance and the DeltaE error we ended up recording was 4. Even the sRGB and DCI-P3 coverage were nothing close to what MSI claimed. Overall, this isn't a great panel, unfortunately.

### KEYBOARD, TRACKPAD, I/O

The keyboard has a nice set of keys with white details on the keycaps, backed by RGB lighting. The key travel

is decent but we found the feedback to be on the softer side. The touchpad has some weird imprints, but they don't do anything nor do they light up.

Coming to the ports, on the left side, you'll find the charging port along with a USB Type-A 3.2 port, and a USB Type-A 2.0 port. Switching to the right side, you will see an RJ-45 connector, an HDMI connector, a USB Type-C 3.2 (Gen. 1) port, another USB Type-A 3.2 (Gen. 1) port, and an audio jack.

### BATTERY LIFE

The MSI Pulse GL66 packs a small 53.5Whr battery inside its chassis that charges via the included 180W AC adapter. On PCMark 10's Modern Office battery test, it only managed to last for 3 hours and 17 minutes. Is that surprising? Not really, because it's a tiny battery at the end of the day that has to power hardware like an i7 processor and an RTX 3060 GPU. In real-world usage, the Pulse GL66 managed to last for about 5-6 hours when we lowered the brightness a little bit.

### VERDICT

The MSI Pulse GL66 is a great gaming laptop that can be used reliably for both gaming as well as creative workloads. The Intel Core i7-11800H and the RTX 3060 combo works very well to deliver solid performance numbers when it comes to 1080p gaming. We did find the display to be a little disappointing. But besides that, the MSI Pulse GL66 hits the sweet spot for 1080p gaming.

—Karthik Iyer

### SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-11800H - 8 cores and 16 threads. Base clock - 3.1GHz & boost clock of 4.2GHz | GRAPHICS: Nvidia GeForce RTX 3060 GPU with 6GB GDDR6 VRAM. Up to 1485MHz Boost Clock, 85W Maximum Graphics Power with Dynamic Boost | RAM: 16GB DDR4 3200MHz | STORAGE: 2x M.2 SSD slot (NVMe PCIe Gen3) | DISPLAY: 15.6" FHD (1920x1080), 144Hz, IPS-Level

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